

CURL CHEAT SHEET

CYBERSECURITY, API TESTING & BUG BOUNTY ESSENTIALS

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BASIC SYNTAX & GET / POST

```
curl [options] URL
```

GET Request (Default):

```
curl https://example.com
curl -X GET https://example.com
```

POST Request:

```
curl -X POST https://example.com/login
```

SENDING DATA

Form Data:

```
curl -X POST -d "username=admin&password=1234"
https://example.com/login
```

JSON Data:

```
curl -X POST -H "Content-Type: application/json" -d
'{"username":"admin","password":"1234"}' https://
example.com/login
```

Multiple Data Fields / URL-Encoded:

```
curl -d "user=admin" -d "pass=1234" URL
curl --data-urlencode "search=hello world" URL
```

HTTP METHODS REFERENCE

Method	Command
GET	<code>curl URL</code>
POST	<code>curl -X POST URL</code>
PUT	<code>curl -X PUT URL</code>
DELETE	<code>curl -X DELETE URL</code>
PATCH	<code>curl -X PATCH URL</code>
OPTIONS	<code>curl -X OPTIONS URL</code>
HEAD	<code>curl -I URL</code>

HEADERS & COOKIES

Custom Headers:

```
curl -H "User-Agent: Mozilla/5.0" URL
curl -H "Authorization: Bearer TOKEN" -H "Content-
Type: application/json" URL
```

Cookies Management:

```
curl --cookie "PHPSESSID=abc123" URL
curl -b cookies.txt URL          # Send from file
curl -c cookies.txt URL          # Save cookies
curl -D headers.txt URL          # Save response
headers
```

PENETRATION TESTING COMMANDS

Enumerate Headers: `curl -I https://target.com`

Inspect Full Traffic: `curl -v https://target.com`

Test Login:

```
curl -X POST -d "username=admin&password=password"
https://target.com/login
```

Authenticated API Call:

```
curl -H "Authorization: Bearer JWT_TOKEN" https://
target.com/api/profile
```

Test File Upload (Web Shell):

```
curl -F "file=@shell.php" https://target.com/upload
```

Virtual Host Routing:

```
curl -H "Host: admin.target.com" http://
192.168.1.10
```

CORS / OPTIONS Test:

```
curl -H "Origin: https://evil.com" -X OPTIONS -i
URL
```

DNS Override:

```
curl --resolve example.com:443:1.2.3.4 https://
example.com
```

RESPONSE CONTROL & INSPECTION

```
curl -L URL                # Follow Redirects
curl -k https://example.com # Ignore SSL Cert
curl -i URL                # Show Headers +
Body
curl -I URL                # Headers Only
curl -v URL                # Verbose Mode
curl -s URL                # Silent Mode
curl -sS URL               # Silent with Errors
curl -A "Mozilla/5.0" URL  # User-Agent
curl -e "https://google.com" URL# Referer
```

AUTHENTICATION & FILES

Basic Auth & Bearer Token:

```
curl -u username:password URL
curl -H "Authorization: Bearer TOKEN" URL
```

File Uploads:

```
curl -F "file=@image.jpg" URL
curl -F "file1=@a.txt" -F "file2=@b.txt" URL
curl -F "username=admin" -F "password=1234" URL
```

File Downloads:

```
curl -O URL # Remote filename
curl -o output.html URL # Custom filename
curl -C - -O URL # Resume download
```

BURP SUITE & PROXY WORKFLOW

Route traffic through proxy (e.g., Burp Suite):

```
curl -x http://127.0.0.1:8080 URL
curl -x http://127.0.0.1:8080 -k -v https://
example.com
```

CUSTOM FORMAT VARIABLES (-w)

View Status Code Only:

```
curl -o /dev/null -s -w "%{http_code}"
" URL
```

Print Execution Metrics:

```
curl -w "Status: %{http_code}
Time: %{time_total}
IP: %{remote_ip}
" -o /dev/null -s URL
```

Variable	Description
<code>%{http_code}</code>	HTTP status code
<code>%{time_total}</code>	Total request time
<code>%{remote_ip}</code>	Server IP address
<code>%{size_download}</code>	Downloaded bytes
<code>%{content_type}</code>	Response Content-Type
<code>%{url_effective}</code>	Final URL post-redirect

ESSENTIAL FLAGS QUICK GUIDE

Flag	Meaning	Flag	Meaning
<code>-X</code>	HTTP Method	<code>-L</code>	Follow Redirects
<code>-H</code>	Header	<code>-k</code>	Ignore SSL
<code>-d</code>	POST Data	<code>-v</code>	Verbose Output
<code>-F</code>	Multipart Form	<code>-s</code>	Silent Mode
<code>-u</code>	Basic Auth	<code>-x</code>	HTTP Proxy
<code>-b/-c</code>	Cookie Read/Save	<code>--http2</code>	Force HTTP/2